*A faceless being* stands over the table. Its head, swathed in white—a mask wrapped tightly around the skull, leaving the crown bare, with seams visible where the cloth strains against the bone. The fabric presses against the nasal bridge, flattening cartilage into an abstract ridge, a geometric point rather than a feature. It sinks into the orbital hollows where eyes should be, carving shadows that refuse to resolve into gaze. Around the mouth, the cloth gathers, pinched into a faint cavity that suggests breath but denies expression.

The body is clothed in white as well. Not quite a coat, not quite a robe. Precise in its tailoring yet spectral in effect. The shoulders are padded, squared, almost architectural, before dropping into arms that fall wide and straight, cut bluntly at the wrist. The neckline dips into a V, the waist cinched, the rest cascading in a vertical fall of fabric.

The figure leans forward, neither doctor nor priest but something between, its hands already reaching for the hide stretched across the table...

*Written by Ahliyah Luna*
*Design by Krista Vener*

# CAFÉ DE LA

The being lays out cotton across the floo
multiples—one, then twenty, then fifty-t
shadows. In Tabi boots, they descend int
toes bleed across fabric, each impressio

*The upper* begins with a calf, muscle taut under meadow sun. Salt stiffened the hide, and knives traced their choreography—first scoring the outline, then dragging clean lines through fleshd, pulling it into shape. Flank to panel, panel to pattern, pattern to future. Pits of tannin soaked it until the hide darkened, softened, and scraped thin, shaved into pliant nappa. A blade cut the cleft between the toes, leaving it open. The being reached for another hide—a goat—thinner, softer, porous. Dyed a pale cream, it will lie against flesh, absorbing sweat, oil, and odor —the intimacies of a body moving inside it—a hidden archive written in salt. The goat is stitched to the calf, two animals spliced into one.

The being layers hide again, pressing, gluing, nailing them into strata until the sole becomes a geological formation. A small rubber lift is nailed to the bottom; the nailheads glint, fingerprints of the cobber frozen in memory. The thread pierces leather next, pulling lips of skin together. Sutures, not disguises. In couture, the seam is hidden; here it is revealed. The split toe is the deepest wound, concealed and exalted at once. White paint follows, brushed over layer by layer, obliterating grain, pore, and scar. An unnatural pallor, plaster pulled tight.
***It will not last.***

# GARE, PARIS, *Summer 1988*

loor, stretching it taut until the space itself becomes a blank page. His form
y-two others— each head swathed in white, crowns left exposed, fabric pulling
into pots of red paint—a baptism not of purity but of stain. Step after step, the split
ion a letter, each letter an alphabet in crimson, cloven script pressed into cloth.